

New Faces Accompany Diablos Into Miner Exhibition Game

El Pasoans have their first opportunity to meet the El Paso Diablos at 7 p.m. Monday when the Rojos take on the University of Texas at El Paso in an exhibition game at Dudley Field.

Fifteen players making up the 21-man roster have never played in El Paso before and Monday's game will not only allow them to become acquainted with Dudley Field but it'll also be El Paso's first workout under the lights.

The Rojos have another exhibition game scheduled Tuesday in Juarez against the Indios before beginning the Texas League season Wednesday at home against the Amarillo Gold Sox.

Diablos Manager Bobby Knoop is expected to use both Tom Donohue and Rocky Jordan behind the plate Monday with the rest of the infield consisting of either Lawrence Rush or Willie Aikens at first, Fred Frazier at second, Joe Zagarino will occupy the hot corner and Rance Mulliniks will fill the gap at short.

Marty Friedman, Gil Kubski and Steve Stroughter will be in the outfield. Knoop was undecided upon which pitchers he would use against the Miners.

Left-hander Chuck Gibbon will hurl the TL opener

Wednesday while another familiar name in Frank Panick is scheduled to pitch Thursday.

While the exhibition game will help the Diablos to adjust to Dudley Field, Miner Coach Andy Cohen is also hoping to gain something from the game.

"This will be a good tuneup for us before we make a swing through Arizona this coming weekend," said Cohen, still fuming over Wednesday's doubleheader split with New Mexico.

"I can blame myself for the whole dam thing," he barked. "When we got the lead going into the last inning, I should have pulled (Dave) Jannusch after he walked the first man.

"I didn't think Jannusch had lost his stuff visibly but his wildness made him tired."

Jannusch walked three batters with two outs in the ninth inning and was replaced by Joe Dehn. But an infield fly was dropped when Glenn Villarreal and Keith Dwinell collided while chasing the ball and New Mexico won the game 6-4 after UTEP took the opener 8-2.

"I just hope we can be respectable against the Diablos," said Cohen. "Last year we held them for about five innings before they got to us and won something like 9-4."